Grand Rounds · October 2026

SIGN-OUT

Question 20

Carpal tunnel: median nerve

BLOCK	QUESTION	VIDEO
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What you need to know before moving on.

Question 20

A 34-year-old woman at 31 weeks' gestation comes to the physician because of numbness and tingling of her right hand for 6 weeks. The symptoms wake her at night, and she relieves them by shaking her hand. She has also been dropping small objects while buttoning her clothes.

Examination shows decreased sensation over the palmar surfaces of the thumb, index finger, and middle finger. Sensation over the skin of the thenar eminence and the dorsum of the hand is normal. There is weakness of thumb abduction and opposition. Flexion of the distal interphalangeal joints of the index finger and thumb is normal. Holding both wrists in full flexion for 60 seconds reproduces her symptoms.

Compression of a nerve at which of the following sites best explains these findings?

A	Between the two heads of the pronator teres muscle
B	Deep to the flexor retinaculum at the wrist
C	Within the cubital tunnel at the elbow
D	Within the ulnar (Guyon) canal at the wrist
E	Along the spiral groove of the humerus

ANSWER AND VIDEO ON THE NEXT PAGE

QUESTION 20 · CARPAL TUNNEL: MEDIAN NERVE

Answer B.

Deep to the flexor retinaculum at the wrist

THE CLASS

25%

got it right (3 of 12)

MOST CHOSEN WRONG

D

5 of 12 · Within the ulnar (Guyon) canal at the wrist

Watch the explanation

Opens the video in your browser.